SESSION 1 OF 6 · 3 HOURS

# Beyond Ad Hoc Prompting

## Principles of Structured Prompt Design

MSc in AI and Digital Strategy Management

Advanced Prompting & API Integration




BSB BURGUNDY SCHOOL OF BUSINESS | We believe in you

# Session roadmap

| Time | Block | Format |
|---|---|---|
| 0:00 | Welcome, course arc, why structure matters | Briefing |
| 0:20 | Anatomy of an effective prompt | Briefing + live demo |
| 0:50 | Workshop 1: rewrite a weak prompt | Pairs |
| 1:25 | Break (10 min) | — |
| 1:35 | Common mistakes and quick iteration | Briefing + discussion |
| 2:00 | Workshop 2: compare and evaluate outputs | Groups of 3–4 |
| 2:35 | Workflow project brief and wrap-up | Plenary |

# Anatomy of an effective prompt

01

**Role**

Sets expertise and perspective

*Act as a senior HR business partner*

02

**Context**

Supplies purpose and audience

*For a 40-person retailer launching hybrid work*

03

**Task**

States the core intent

*Draft a one-page announcement email*

04

**Constraints**

Bounds tone, length and rules

*Max 150 words, warm, no jargon*

05

**Output format**

Shapes the structure

*Subject line, three bullets, one call to action*



# One task, two prompts



AD HOC

**“Write an email about our new policy.”**

Typical result: generic tone, unclear audience, length left to chance

STRUCTURED

**“Act as a senior HR business partner. Draft an announcement email on our new hybrid-work policy for a 40-person retailer. Max 150 words, warm but professional. Format: subject line, three bullets, one call to action.”**

Typical result: targeted, consistent and reusable across similar tasks

# Role, audience and tone



## Role

Domain-specific reasoning and vocabulary

*Act as a cybersecurity analyst*

## Audience context

Depth and level of complexity

*Assume the reader has no technical background*

## Tone

Voice and emotional register

*Concise and professional*

## Role + tone

Tailored, professional-sounding result

*Instructional designer, informative yet approachable*



# Common prompting mistakes

| Mistake | Typical symptom | Fix |
|---|---|---|
| Vague request | Generic, unfocused output | Name the criterion: clarity, tone, concision |
| Missing context | Wrong audience or level | State the purpose and the reader |
| Overloaded prompt | Partial or skipped tasks | One task per prompt, or split into steps |
| No output format | Inconsistent layouts | Specify table, bullets, length |
| No success criteria | Quality cannot be judged | Define 3 checks before running |

WORKSHOP 1 · 35 MIN · PAIRS

# Rewrite a weak prompt

1. Pick a weak prompt, or bring your own · 5 min
2. Run it and save the output · 5 min
3. Rewrite with role, context, task, constraints, format · 10 min
4. Run both versions and compare side by side · 10 min
5. Share one insight with the class · 5 min

**Deliverable: a before/after pair with three observed differences**



WORKSHOP 2 · 35 MIN · GROUPS OF 3–4

# Compare and evaluate outputs



| Criterion | Score 1–5: guiding question |
|---|---|
| Relevance | Does it address the real business need? |
| Accuracy | Is anything invented or wrong? |
| Format adherence | Does it follow the requested structure? |
| Tone and audience | Would the target reader accept it? |
| Reusability | Would it work again with new inputs? |

**Swap prompts, rerun them, score blind, then agree on the one change that mattered most.**

# Workflow project brief

Choose a real, repeatable business task that your workflow will improve.

- Clear input and a measurable output
- Done often enough to be worth automating
- Uses public or non-sensitive data
- Suited to prompting now, API calls later

| 1 Prompt design | 2 Prompt chains | 3 API basics | 4 Multi-step workflow | 5 Optimize | 6 Demo |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|

**Before Session 2: select the business task for your workflow project.**

# Further reading

- White et al. (2023), A Prompt Pattern Catalog to Enhance Prompt Engineering with ChatGPT
- Liu et al. (2023), Pre-train, Prompt, and Predict, ACM Computing Surveys
- Ekin (2023), Prompt Engineering for ChatGPT: A Quick Guide
- Mollick, One Useful Thing (newsletter), selected essays
- Official prompting documentation from your AI provider

**Next session: few-shot examples, prompt chains and quality criteria.**

